GROWFIN · NEW-HIRE KIT · ILLUSTRATION · BRAND

Onboarding Stickers

Six stickers for the Growfin welcome kit, picked from fifteen sketched concepts, and the shift away from generic desk humor that decided which ones made it.

— 01 CONTEXT

A small, visible piece of a bigger welcome kit

THE BRIEF

Day one, laptop lid

The sticker sheet is a small but visible part of Growfin's onboarding kit: the kind of thing that ends up on a laptop lid or a notebook, not filed away. It needed to feel personal enough that a new hire would actually want to use it.

THE CHALLENGE

Escaping the office-humor default

The obvious direction for "office stickers" is generic desk humor: coffee jokes, WFH jokes, salary-day jokes. Early sketches leaned into that. The brief then shifted: cut the generic humor down, and split what's left between ideas that are unmistakably Growfin and ones quirky enough to stand on their own.

If a sticker could belong to any company's break room, it didn't belong in this kit.

— 02 APPROACH

Sketch wide, then narrow it down together

THE SKETCHING

~15 concepts roughed out by hand before anything was designed properly.

One lane of **general office & culture humor**: coffee, WFH, salary day, team breaks.

One lane of **Growfin wordplay**, built around the fin mark: Finesse, Finergy, FinSamentally.

One lane of **quirky, brand-agnostic ideas** with no direct pun or logo tie-in.

THE SELECTION

The **marketing manager** shortlisted from the full sketch sheet first.

The wider **team voted** on what they liked and what didn't land.

The two rounds together fixed the **final six**.

Not one of the generic office-humor sketches made the final set.

— 03 EXPLORATION

Fifteen sketches, three lanes, one shortlist

Every concept started as a rough hand drawing, cheap enough to throw away and honest enough to argue over. The set was then numbered and laid out as a single sheet, so it could be reviewed and voted on as a list rather than a wall of drawings.

LANE 01
Office & culture humor *(cut)*
Coffee, WFH, salary day, team breaks: familiar desk-culture jokes, kept the sketch sheet honest; none reached the final six.

LANE 02
Growfin wordplay
Puns built on the fin mark: Fintastic, Finesse, Finergy, Growfin itself. The backbone of the final selection.

LANE 03
Quirky, brand-agnostic
Ideas with no logo or pun attached, just something people would want to keep, like Moments Memories Milestones.



FIG. 01: CONCEPT SKETCHES, NUMBERED 1–15 FOR REVIEW

— 04 SELECTION

The six that shipped

Manager pick and team vote agreed on the same six, then polished up, colored, and mocked up on an actual laptop lid to check they'd hold up outside the sketchbook.



FIG. 02: FINAL SIX, APPLIED TO A LAPTOP MOCKUP

01 Loading Fintastic	02 Finesse Is My Superpower
03 Growfin wordmark	04 The fin mark, standalone
05 Ride the Wave	06 Moments, Memories, Milestones

— 05 OUTCOME

From a pile of sketches to a kit that reads as Growfin

15 / 6
CONCEPTS SKETCHED, DOWN TO STICKERS SHIPPED

0 / 6
GENERIC OFFICE-HUMOR JOKES IN THE FINAL SET

The final set leans on the fin mark and Growfin wordplay for most of its personality, balanced by **Moments, Memories, Milestones**, the one idea in the set that isn't tied to the logo or a pun, kept because the team voted for it anyway.

WHY THIS PROJECT

It's a small deliverable, but the same discipline applies as anywhere else: sketch more than you need, let more than one opinion decide what survives, and be willing to cut the easy, generic answer even after it's already drawn.